

Wyoming Roadless Areas Survey

Sources, Background, and Further Reading

These links are provided for voters who want to review the source material. Source review is optional and is not required to answer the survey. The questions are intended to measure opinion, not persuade.

Why this survey was created

Wyoming has more than 3 million acres of inventoried roadless areas on National Forest System lands. A current federal rulemaking process is considering rescission of the 2001 Roadless Rule, and H.R. 7695 would make the 2001 rule have no force or effect while requiring certain permanent and temporary roads where deemed necessary. This creates a timely Wyoming question: what standards should guide our voice before decisions are made?

Short neutral background

The 2001 Roadless Rule generally limited new road construction, road reconstruction, and timber harvest in inventoried roadless areas, with limited exceptions. USDA and the Forest Service argue that rescission would return more decision-making to local land managers and improve flexibility for wildfire risk, forest health, timber work, and rural economies. Conservation and recreation groups argue that roadless protections help protect water, wildlife habitat, backcountry hunting and fishing, recreation, solitude, and long-term public-land inheritance. The survey asks Wyoming voters to weigh these values and choose standards for decision-making.

Key distinctions

- Inventoried roadless area is not the same as congressionally designated Wilderness.
- A temporary road is intended for a limited project or emergency purpose; a permanent road remains for long-term use.
- Rule changes do not automatically approve every project. Project-level review, forest plans, laws, and public process can still matter.
- The public question is not only protection versus development. It is also about water, fire, access, wildlife, costs, accountability, and local judgment.

Official sources

[USDA Forest Service - Roadless Areas](https://www.fs.usda.gov/managing-land/planning/roadless)

<https://www.fs.usda.gov/managing-land/planning/roadless>

Official overview of the 2001 Roadless Rule, current rulemaking status, and GIS/map resources.

[Federal Register - Special Areas; Roadless Area Conservation; National Forest System Lands](https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2025/08/29/2025-16581/special-areas-roadless-area-conservation-national-forest-system-lands)

<https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2025/08/29/2025-16581/special-areas-roadless-area-conservation-national-forest-system-lands>

Official notice of intent, public-comment timeline, purpose, proposed action, and issues for review.

[USDA Forest Service - Roadless Areas by State](https://www.fs.usda.gov/managing-land/planning/roadless/state-maps)

<https://www.fs.usda.gov/managing-land/planning/roadless/state-maps>

Official state acreage summaries and map links, including Wyoming.

[USDA Forest Service - Wyoming Roadless Areas Map PDF](https://www.fs.usda.gov/sites/default/files/roadless-map-wyoming-high-resolution-fsmrs-072382.pdf)

<https://www.fs.usda.gov/sites/default/files/roadless-map-wyoming-high-resolution-fsmrs-072382.pdf>

Printable map showing Wyoming inventoried roadless areas on National Forest System lands.

[USDA - June 23, 2025 announcement](https://www.usda.gov/about-usda/news/press-releases/2025/06/23/secretary-rollins-rescinds-roadless-rule-eliminating-impediment-responsible-forest-management)

<https://www.usda.gov/about-usda/news/press-releases/2025/06/23/secretary-rollins-rescinds-roadless-rule-eliminating-impediment-responsible-forest-management>

Agency statement explaining the management-flexibility and wildfire-risk argument for rescission.

[USDA Forest Service - August 27, 2025 next step](https://www.fs.usda.gov/about-agency/newsroom/releases/usda-opens-next-step-roadless-rule-rescission)

<https://www.fs.usda.gov/about-agency/newsroom/releases/usda-opens-next-step-roadless-rule-rescission>

Agency statement announcing public comment and environmental impact statement process.

[H.R. 7695 bill text](#)

<https://docs.house.gov/meetings/II/II10/20260521/119263/BILLS-119HR7695ih.pdf>

Bill text addressing nullification of the 2001 rule and required road construction language.

Wyoming and public-interest sources

[Wyoming Wilderness Association - Maps](#)

<https://www.wildwyo.org/maps>

Includes a roadless areas interactive map and conservation-focused explanation.

[Wyoming Outdoor Council - Roadless Rule article](#)

<https://wyomingoutdoorcouncil.org/2025/09/03/roadless-rule/>

Protection-focused Wyoming discussion of roadless-area values and concerns.

[Greater Yellowstone Coalition - Roadless Rule page](#)

<https://greateryellowstone.org/roadless-rule>

Protection-focused regional discussion of roadless lands in the Greater Yellowstone area.

[BlueRibbon Coalition - Roadless Rule rescission comment page](#)

<https://blueribboncoalition.org/usda-accepting-comments-on-roadless-rule-rescission-support-this-win-for-public-land-access/>

Access and management-flexibility focused discussion supporting rescission.

[University of Wyoming College of Law - The Long Road to Rescinding the Roadless Rule](#)

<https://www.uwyo.edu/law/centers/center-for-land-and-water-law/blog/long-road-rescinding-roadless-rule.html>

Legal-process overview of rescission, NEPA, consultation, public comment, and litigation risk.

Questions to consider while reading

- Which areas are Wilderness, which are inventoried roadless areas, and which are other public lands?
- Which proposed actions would use temporary roads, and which would create permanent roads?
- What water, wildlife, fire, access, and cost information should be published before a decision?
- How should Wyoming voices be gathered, reported, and compared with future decisions?